INVENTORY · STACK · PROSE

list

Bulleted list under a heading — plain pills, hairline takeaways (optionally numbered criteria with a gloss line), or display-weight principles.

The list states one point per line.

- A line is a complete statement, not a fragment.
- Fourteen words is the budget a line may spend.
- Six lines fill the canvas comfortably.
- Parallel openings keep the scan honest.
- Nesting belongs to card layouts, not here.

takeaway boxes the list as findings.

The box frames the lines as conclusions.

Lead with the strongest finding.

Five lines read as a verdict.

Longer sets go back to plain list.

principles numbers the house rules.

01 State each rule as an imperative.

02 Keep rules under ten words.

03 Order them by how often they apply.

04 Retire a rule you keep breaking.

Criteria are gates: clear them in order.

01 **State the bar**

Each criterion is a pass-or-fail line, not a preference.

02 **Order by veto power**

The criterion most likely to kill goes first.

03 **Keep the list short**

Three gates decide; six gates stall.

lettered counts the rules with letters.

A Letters read as options, not sequence.

B Use them when order is arbitrary.

C Three options is a decision; six is a menu.

roman sets the rules in numerals.

I Numerals lend formal weight.

II Reserve them for charters and mandates.

III Past five, the gravitas becomes parody.

bullet strips the markers back to dots.

- Dots drop the counting entirely.
- The principles frame stays.
- Use when rules are peers.

Six lines is the most a list should carry.

- A stress line may spend fourteen words, and this one shows where the wrap lands.
- At the ceiling every line stays one complete statement with one clause of support.
- The third line is where a reading audience starts skimming instead.
- Vary sentence length or six dense lines blur into one.
- Numbers and names hold attention better than abstractions here.
- Six is the stop; seven becomes a memo.

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When NOT to reach for list.

Title plus body per item

If each bullet is `**Title.** body` on one line, the layout under-serves it. Nest the body as a `- gloss` bullet under a `takeaway` item (the lead then stacks over it), or move to cards-stack (2-3 items) or list-tabular (5+ rows).

Wall of long bullets

Past twelve words per line the slide becomes paragraph soup. Either trim or move to content for prose, cards-stack for structured items.

Two-item lists

Two bullets read as a thin slide. For pairs, reach for compare-prose — it gives the pair the weight it deserves.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`cards-stack` — each item has a title plus body sentence

`list-tabular` — five or more rows with label-plus-description

`checklist` — items carry state markers (done / partial / todo)